



WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Nippon Steel** received a conditional green light from Trump to take control of U.S. Steel under what he called a partnership, but key aspects of the deal need to be ironed out. **A1**

◆ **Stock markets** slid this week amid fears of a deficit crisis and renewed angst over tariffs. The S&P 500 ended the week down 2.6%, while the Dow and Nasdaq both fell 2.5%. **B11**

◆ **Boeing and the Justice** Department reached a tentative agreement for the plane maker to pay \$1.1 billion to avoid prosecution for two passenger-jet crashes. **B9**

◆ **The nation's biggest** banks are exploring whether to team up to issue a joint stablecoin, a step intended to fend off competition from the crypto industry. **B9**

◆ **Booz Allen** plans to cut roughly 2,500 jobs after the consulting company warned that it is feeling the effects of the Trump administration's crackdown on contracting. **B9**

◆ **JBS shareholders** approved a plan that would restructure the world's biggest meat company and allow it to list its shares on the NYSE. **B9**

World-Wide

◆ **President Trump** fired new salvos in the global trade war, threatening a 50% tariff on imported goods from the EU and new duties on iPhones and other smartphones made overseas. **A1**

◆ **More than 100** National Security Council officials have been removed from their roles or detailed back to their agencies, part of a broader restructuring process. **A4**

◆ **A federal judge** temporarily blocked the government's bid to prevent Harvard University from enrolling international students. **A3**

◆ **Ukraine and Russia** completed the first day of what is expected to be the largest prisoner swap of the war, with each side expected to get back 1,000 people. **A8**

◆ **Iran and the U.S.** are aiming to set the parameters for a new deal on Tehran's nuclear program, while leaving important details still to be negotiated. **A8**

◆ **Trump aims to accelerate** the slow-moving nuclear power industry through a series of executive orders. **A4**

◆ **Taiwan will commission** its first army drone units and add underwater drones to modernize its arsenal. **A9**

NOONAN

Memorial Day and best movies of our lives. **A13**

NOTICE TO READERS

WSJ.com and WSJ mobile apps will publish throughout the holiday weekend. The Wall Street Journal print edition won't be published on Monday, Memorial Day.

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Ukraine, Russia Begin Large Prisoner Exchange



SERHI KOROVANYI FOR WSJ

HOMECOMING: Ukrainian prisoners of war and civilians returned home Friday at the country's northern border with Russia on the first day of what is expected to be the largest swap of the war. Each side is set to get back 1,000 people. **A8**

Retail Investors Grow Queasy In Squeeze of Market Volatility

By HANNAH ERIN LANG AND DALVIN BROWN

When a chunk of Bill Jensen's retirement savings got wiped away in early April, he started to second-guess himself. His wife urged him to consider switching their savings from stocks into safer investments, but Jensen insisted they wait for the market to rebound. The retired 68-year-old tried to reassure both of them by sending emails showing the

gains when their portfolio ended in the green. Seven weeks later, the couple's investments had recovered most losses, Jensen said. But rather than taking his risk down a notch, he recommitted to the stock market. This week, stocks fell again. The S&P 500 retreated 2.6%, its largest weekly decline since early April, the week of President Trump's globe-spanning tariff announcement. The benchmark index declined 0.7%

on Friday after Trump threatened new tariffs on the European Union and on iPhones made overseas, adding fuel to the trade fears. Such is the gut-wrenching nature of being a buy-and-hold stock investor these days, with volatility poised to continue. The spring's tariff turmoil has been a sudden shift for investors who were rewarded with steady gains and few prolonged slumps for their portfolios over the prior

two years. It has marked a major test of individual investors' risk tolerances. "You have to take the good with the bad," said Jensen, who added that he had "some moments of regret" during the April selloff. It is a truism of long-term investing not to sell in the middle of market upheaval. But that can be excruciating right now, investors said. Jon Ulin, managing princi- Please turn to page A2

Nippon's Deal With U.S. Steel To Advance

By BOB TITA AND LAUREN THOMAS

Nippon Steel received a conditional green light from President Trump to take control of U.S. Steel under what he described as a partnership. Key aspects of the deal still need to be ironed out. But Trump's announcement signaled that the Tokyo-based company could eventually enter the American steel market and make the big investments envisioned when it reached a \$14.1 billion deal to take over U.S. Steel. Trump's defining the agreement as a partnership spurred some confusion at the companies on Friday afternoon, according to people involved in the deal talks. Both Nippon and U.S. Steel were seeking more guidance from the administration about how much ownership Nippon could ultimately gain. In a post on Truth Social Friday, Trump wrote that the partnership between the two companies would result in at least 70,000 jobs, and add \$14 billion to the U.S. economy. The bulk of that investment will occur in the next 14 months, he wrote. "For many years, the name, 'United States Steel' was synonymous with Greatness, and now, it will be again," he wrote, adding that the company's headquarters would remain in Please turn to page A6

INSIDE



EXCHANGE
Universal's \$7 billion arms race with Disney World. **B1**

U.S. NEWS
Court pauses ban on foreign students at Harvard. **A3**

MAGA Memecoin Gala Draws Super Wealthy—and Protests

By ALEXANDER OSIPOVICH AND VICKY GE HUANG

The cryptocurrency industry's lovefest with MAGA reached a pinnacle when President Trump convened top buyers of his memecoin for a gala dinner Thursday. Trump's message: He was fulfilling his promise to make the U.S. the "crypto capital" of the world. "And we're doing it. Rapidly," he said in remarks at the dinner at his golf club outside Washington, according to a recording captured by one of the attendees.

In the ballroom, a crowd of admirers cheered on Trump and the fledgling market's ascendance since his election. Among them was the crypto billionaire Justin Sun, whose large stake of \$TRUMP coins assured him a spot in Trump's VIP reception at the event, and former basketball star Lamar Odom, who recently launched his own memecoin. Outside, on a damp spring evening, protesters waved signs highlighting the unusual circumstances that brought the president and the crypto industry together: A dinner

exclusively for those who bought digital coins Trump issued earlier this year. "Stop Crypto Corruption," one sign read. Sen. Jeff Merkley (D., Ore.) joined protesters' chants, calling the dinner "the Mount Everest of Corruption," according to video clips on X. Unveiled in late April, the dinner was thrown open to the 220 largest holders of the memecoin. The 25 largest holders were eligible for a short VIP reception with Trump before the dinner. It was unclear if all of the spots Please turn to page A4

An Ode to the Penny, For 233 Years of Service

* * *

It's been around nearly as long as America, but the coin eventually lost its shine

By OYIN ADEDOYIN AND KEN THOMAS

A penny saved was a penny earned. A penny bought your thoughts. A penny was pretty. A penny was pinched. A penny might even be hiding in your loafer. There won't be as much of that anymore. The Treasury Department said this week it was phasing out the penny. After a lifespan nearly as long as the nation itself,



Coin toss

America's one-cent coin will begin to fade from the money supply. The U.S. Mint has ordered its last batch of the blanks used to mint the coins, and the Treasury expects to stop putting them into circulation early next year. The penny's reputation has shifted over more than two centuries. At times a symbol of thriftiness, practicality and even luck, the penny more recently has come to symbolize Please turn to page A10

Son of Trump's Envoy Pushes Foreign Deals

Zach Witkoff pitches Trump family crypto

By REBECCA BALLHAUS AND ANGUS BERWICK

A month before President Trump's inauguration, Middle East envoy Steve Witkoff flew to the United Arab Emirates with two goals: discussing regional issues with the Abu Dhabi royal known as the "spy sheikh," and attending a cryptocurrency conference. Less than five months later, Witkoff's son, co-founder of the crypto venture World Liberty Financial, took the stage at a conference in Dubai to announce the com-

pany had struck a deal for the sheikh's company to buy \$2 billion of their new cryptocurrency. The expected tens of millions of dollars in annual profits would be split between the Witkoffs and their co-founders—and the Trump family, which holds a 60% stake in the company. On May 15, the elder Witkoff and the sheikh, Tahnoun bin Zayed al Nahyan, met again, this time for the unveiling of an agreement, long sought by the U.A.E., that gives the oil-rich Gulf monar- Please turn to page A10